INC-2026-05-29: Web application where merchants view transactions and payout degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV3 · service merchant-portal · author t.lindqvist

Started 2026-05-29T02:00:00Z · detected 2026-05-29T02:07:00Z · resolved 2026-05-29T02:32:00Z

Customer impact

The merchant portal transaction page timed out for 35 minutes. No data was exposed across merchant boundaries; the query failed before returning rows.

Root cause

A reporting query lost its merchant_id predicate during a refactor, so the transaction list query scanned the whole ledger replica.

Causing change

This incident was caused by release portal-4.0.2, deployed to merchant-portal. The release is recorded in the change log.

Affected services

merchant-portal. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on merchant-portal.

Timeline (UTC)

02:00 — Release portal-4.0.2 completed rollout earlier in the day.

02:00 — First symptoms observed on merchant-portal.

02:07 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for merchant-portal.

02:15 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

02:32 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Document the mitigation steps in the service runbook.

• Add saturation alerting to merchant-portal at 80% of limits.

• Review the third-party contract for change notification.